

Update 1.7.0 — “Legacy of the Dragonborn”

Release Date: March 20, 2026

Platforms: PC, PlayStation, Xbox

Download Size: 2.4 GB (PC) / 2.6 GB (Console)

Overview

Update 1.7.0 introduces a new questline centered on the ancient Dragonborn shrines of Skyrim, rebalances late-game combat and crafting, and resolves a wide range of issues reported since Update 1.6.

New Features

- **New Questline: “Shrines of the First Dragonborn”** — A five-quest chain beginning at the Throat of the World, sending players to recover fragments of an ancient Akaviri relic scattered across three previously unmarked ruins.
- **New Shout: Frost Render (Fo Krah Diin)** — A three-word shout that roots enemies in place with creeping frost. Word locations added to two existing dungeons.
- **New Follower: Brynjar Stonehand** — A former Companion recruitable in Whiterun after completing “The Silver Hand,” with unique dialogue reacting to the player’s guild affiliations.
- **Homestead Expansion** — Added a smithing annex and greenhouse building option to all three original homestead plots (Hearthfire).
- **New Difficulty Option: Legendary+** — Increases enemy scaling beyond Legendary and disables fast travel while any bounty is active.

Gameplay Improvements

- Dragon AI now varies attack patterns based on terrain, favoring diving attacks in open areas and perching behavior in mountainous regions.
- Followers now reposition during combat instead of clustering around the player, reducing accidental friendly-fire incidents with AoE spells.
- Horses no longer attempt to climb slopes steeper than 45 degrees; they will now path around obstacles instead.
- Lockpicking difficulty now scales more gradually between Novice and Master, smoothing the previous difficulty spike at Adept.
- Guards will now recognize disguises (Thieves Guild armor, Dark Brotherhood shrouds) at a reduced detection radius rather than instantly.

Balance Changes

- **Fus Ro Dah (Unrelenting Force):** Third word stagger duration reduced by 15% against human enemies to prevent chain-stunlocking in PvP-style Legendary+ runs.
- **Conjuration:** Bound weapon damage scaling adjusted to remain competitive through end-game content without requiring perk investment in Destruction.
- **Smithing:** Daedric armor material costs increased; Ebony smithing perk now required as a prerequisite.
- **Alchemy:** Poison duration on thrown weapons reduced from 60 to 30 seconds to curb one-shot builds against high-health bosses.
- **Archery:** Bow draw speed with heavy armor equipped now incurs a small penalty, mirroring the existing spellcasting penalty.

Bug Fixes

- Fixed an issue where placing a bucket on an NPC's head no longer reliably prevented detection of theft (this was never intended behavior, but we know you'll miss it).
- Fixed a quest-blocking issue in "Diplomatic Immunity" where the Thalmor Embassy party could fail to trigger if the player entered through the kitchen first.
- Fixed dragon souls occasionally failing to absorb when killed with certain follower-cast spells.
- Fixed an issue where married followers could become permanently unavailable as followers after moving into a player home.
- Fixed floating grass and rock decals appearing near Solitude and Riften docks after the Update 1.6 lighting pass.
- Fixed an infinite loading screen that could occur when fast-traveling to Blackreach immediately after a dragon fight.
- Fixed several instances of NPCs referring to the player by the wrong title after becoming Thane of a hold.

Performance & Stability

- Reduced frame-rate drops in Whiterun and Solitude on Ultra settings by optimizing crowd NPC scheduling.
- Fixed a memory leak that could occur during extended play sessions involving frequent cell transitions (e.g., repeated dungeon delving).
- Improved load times for saves with high mod/DLC content on console platforms.

Known Issues

- Rare cases of dragons landing inside solid geometry near Dragon's Reach are still under investigation.
- Some players report Brynjar Stonehand's dialogue not updating correctly if recruited before completing the Companions questline; a follow-up patch is planned.
- Greenhouse crops in the Homestead Expansion may not visually mature until the player re-enters the cell.

This is a hypothetical release notes document created for portfolio and demonstration purposes. It does not represent an actual update, patch, or official communication from Bethesda Game Studios.